

POTOROOS

This family contains potoroos, bettongs, and rat kangaroos, small marsupials with many similarities to the larger Macropodidae. However, unlike them, the Potoroidae as adults have a single serrated upper and lower premolar in each side of the jaws.

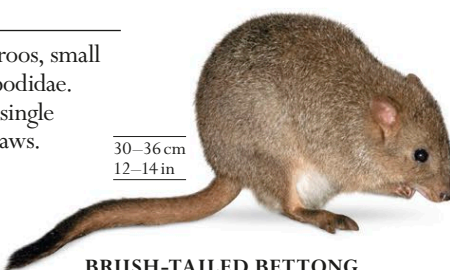


26–41 cm
10–16 in

LONG-NOSED POTOROO

Potorous tridactylus

Inhabiting heath and forest in S.E. Australia, this potoroo has strong, curved claws that help it to dig for underground fungi.



30–36 cm
12–14 in

BRUSH-TAILED BETTONG

Bettongia penicillata

This bettong lives in forest and grassland in S.W. Australia. It has a prehensile tail that it uses for moving nesting material.

RAT-KANGAROO

The musky rat-kangaroo is the sole member of the family Hypsiprymnodontidae. It is relatively primitive; unlike other kangaroo species, it has a first toe, which is opposable and helps it grip.



15–28 cm
6–11 in

MUSKY RAT-KANGAROO

Hypsiprymnodon moschatus

This diurnal species inhabits tropical rainforest in N. Queensland, Australia, where it forages for fallen fruits, seeds, and fungi.



49–69 cm
19½–27 in

NORTHERN NAIL-TAILED WALLABY

Onychogalea unguifera

Also called the sandy nail-tailed wallaby, this medium-sized kangaroo occurs across N. Australia.

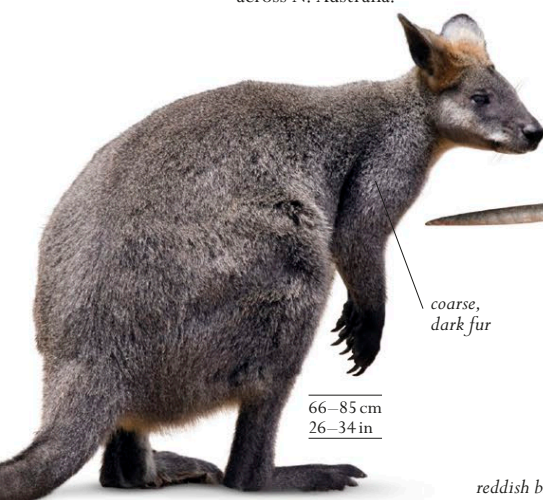


34–109 cm
13½–43 in

BRIDLED NAIL-TAIL WALLABY

Onychogalea fraenata

This nocturnal wallaby was once thought to be extinct; the only remaining wild population is in a small area of Queensland, Australia.



66–85 cm
26–34 in

SWAMP WALLABY

Wallabia bicolor

Darker in colour than other wallabies, the swamp wallaby lives in tropical and temperate forests, and swampland in E. Australia.



31–39 cm
12–15½ in

RUFIOUS HARE-WALLABY

Lagorchestes hirsutus

Previously inhabiting the Australian mainland, the mala or rufous hare-wallaby now exists in the wild on only two islands in Western Australia.



54–77 cm
21½–30 in

BROWN DORCOPSIS

Dorcopsis muelleri

This forest-dwelling kangaroo is endemic to the low-altitude rainforests of western New Guinea, and three offshore islands.

RED-NECKED PADAMELON

Thylogale thetis

A forest wallaby from eastern Australia, this species ventures to the forest edge at night to feed on grass, leaves, and shoots.



29–63 cm
11½–25 in

muscular
thighs

long, narrow
sole of foot



40–54 cm
16–21½ in

QUOKKA

Setonix brachyurus

Rare in mainland Australia, this small marsupial is found on Rottnest and Bald Islands, off the southwestern coast.



55–78 cm
22–30¾ in

DORIA'S TREE KANGAROO

Dendrolagus dorianus

The heaviest of the tree-dwelling marsupials, Doria's tree kangaroo frequently descends to the ground. It lives in montane forest in New Guinea.

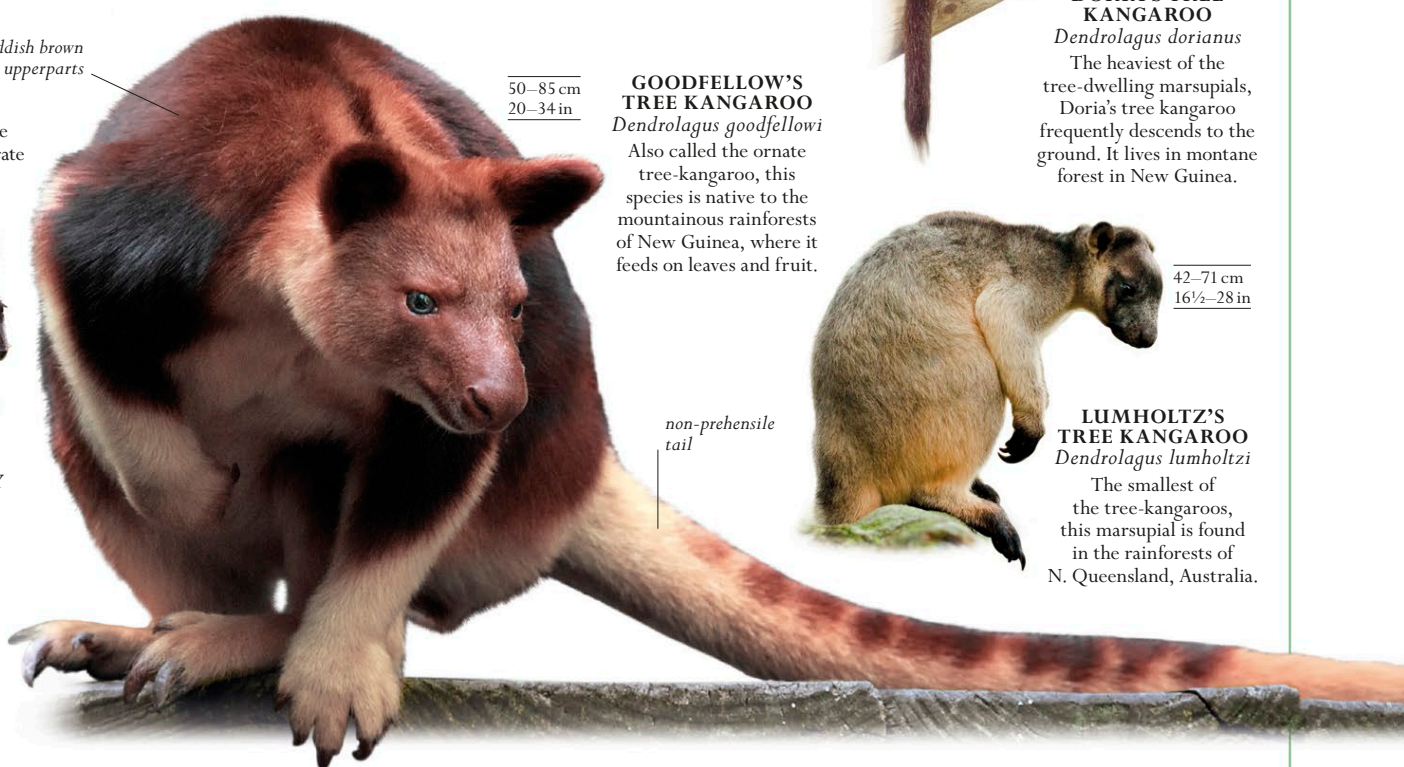


51–62 cm
20–24 in

BRUSH-TAILED ROCK WALLABY

Petrogale penicillata

This resident of S.E. Australia has roughened, padded hind feet that help it to grip when jumping in rocky habitats.



50–85 cm
20–34 in

GOODFELLOW'S TREE KANGAROO

Dendrolagus goodfellowi

Also called the ornate tree-kangaroo, this species is native to the mountainous rainforests of New Guinea, where it feeds on leaves and fruit.

non-prehensile
tail



42–71 cm
16½–28 in

LUMHOLTZ'S TREE KANGAROO

Dendrolagus lumholtzi

The smallest of the tree-kangaroos, this marsupial is found in the rainforests of N. Queensland, Australia.